MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERISTY, KOTTAYAM
MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION OCTOBER 2025
Third Semester
Value Addition Course (VAC) – MG3VACFSQ201- SOFT SKILLS AND PERSONALITY DEVELOPMENT

Part A
MCQ
Answer all questions
Each question carries 1 mark

1. b) Encourages proactive efforts and growth
2. b) Noise
3. a) Stronger trust and collaboration
4. a) Improving personal growth and social interaction
5. a) Helps maintain balance
6. a) Adjust easily
7. d) Simple words
8. b) To practice real-life scenarios in a controlled setting
9. c) Brush your teeth
10. c) Capture audience interest and present the purpose
11. c) Clarifies understanding
12. b) "Please hold for a moment while I check this for you."
13. b) Acknowledge others perspectives respectfully
14. d) It distracts others and shows disrespect
15. b) Share an official correction politely
16. b) Writing in all capital letters
17. c) Cross functional team
18. b) Clean it immediately or report it
19. b) Using precise language, visuals, and structured sections
20. a) It reinforces courtesy and professionalism

(20X1Mark=20)

Part B
Short Answer
Answer any five questions
Each question carries 4 marks

21) Discuss some ways to develop creative thinking in daily life

- Keep an open mind and explore new ideas regularly.
- Engage in brainstorming or mind-mapping activities.
- Read widely from different subjects and cultures.
- Practice problem-solving from different perspectives.
- Maintain a journal to record new thoughts and inspirations.
- Spend time in creative hobbies such as drawing, music, or writing.
- Question assumptions and look for alternative approaches.

22) Describe the benefits of planning your tasks in advance

- Helps manage time effectively and reduces stress.
- Ensures better organization and prioritization of work.
- Improves productivity and efficiency.
- Avoids last-minute confusion or errors.
- Provides a sense of control and direction.

- Enables tracking of progress and timely completion of goals.

23) Identify ways to use language appropriately in different situations

- Choose formal language in professional or academic settings.
- Use polite and respectful expressions when speaking to elders or superiors.
- Adapt tone and vocabulary to suit the audience (e.g., friends vs. clients).
- Avoid slang or offensive terms in formal contexts.
- Use simple, clear, and concise language for effective communication.
- Listen carefully and respond appropriately to maintain context.

24) Discuss the Don'ts in a group discussion

- Don't interrupt or talk over others.
- Don't dominate the discussion or ignore other viewpoints.
- Don't get into personal arguments or show aggression.
- Don't deviate from the topic.
- Don't use disrespectful or offensive language.
- Don't remain silent throughout — participation is key.
- Don't neglect body language; stay attentive and engaged.

25) Describe the importance of body language in an interview

- Reflects confidence, honesty, and enthusiasm.
- Creates a positive first impression on the interviewer.
- Supports verbal communication through gestures and expressions.
- Maintains professionalism through eye contact and posture.
- Helps convey interest and attentiveness.
- Reduces nervousness when used naturally and appropriately.

26) Discuss how a cover letter complements a résumé during a job application

- A cover letter introduces the candidate and highlights suitability for the job.
- It provides context to the résumé and personalizes the application.
- Explains how specific skills and experiences match the job requirements.
- Demonstrates communication skills and professionalism.
- Helps the employer understand the candidate's motivation and interest.
- Strengthens the résumé by giving it a personal and persuasive touch.

27) Discuss why the tone of a business letter is important in professional communication

- Tone sets the overall impression of professionalism and respect.
- Helps maintain positive relationships with clients or colleagues.
- A polite and courteous tone encourages cooperation and goodwill.
- Prevents misunderstanding or conflict in written communication.
- Reflects the company's values and credibility.
- The right tone ensures clarity, sincerity, and effective message delivery

(5 X 4 Marks=20)

Part C

Long Essay

Answer any 1 questions

Each question carries 10 marks

28) Discuss strategies to handle challenging situations and solve problems with examples

- **Stay calm and composed:** Avoid reacting impulsively; take a moment to think clearly before responding.
  Example: When facing customer complaints, listening patiently helps identify the real issue instead of escalating tension.
- **Identify the root cause:**Analyze the situation carefully to understand the main problem.
  Example: If team deadlines are missed repeatedly, finding out whether it's due to workload or miscommunication helps fix the issue.
- **Generate possible solutions:** Brainstorm different ways to overcome the challenge and weigh their pros and cons.

Example: When facing low sales, trying new marketing techniques or improving product presentation can help.

- **Make a decision and act:** Choose the most practical solution and implement it with confidence.
- **Seek feedback and learn:** Review the outcome, note what worked or failed, and apply that learning to future challenges.
- **Maintain a positive attitude:** Optimism builds resilience and motivates others during tough times.

29) Describe the correct sequence of meeting etiquettes when welcoming a guest in a professional setting

1. **Greet the guest politely** with a warm smile and handshake.
2. **Introduce yourself and your team members** clearly and confidently.
3. **Offer a seat** and make the guest comfortable (provide water or refreshments if appropriate).
4. **Engage in brief courteous conversation** before beginning the meeting.
5. **Start the meeting on time** and outline the agenda clearly.
6. **Maintain professionalism**,avoid interruptions and give full attention.
7. **Conclude respectfully** by thanking the guest for their time and participation.
8. **Escort the guest out** courteously as a gesture of respect and hospitality.

(1 X10 marks =10)